

15

Piece Maneuvers and Strategic Coordination

Understand the jobs of every knight, bishop, rook, queen, and pawn



THIS VOLUME

6

deep lessons

12

lesson positions

30

course pages

Make the famous maneuvers purposeful and know when their usual routes are wrong.

LEARN THE STRUCTURE, THEN THE LINE

A four-pass method for a theory-heavy opening

1. DECODE THE POSITION

Read the board before the moves. Name the center, each side's break, the worst piece, the king-safety difference, and the race clock.

2. UNDERSTAND THE CAUSAL CHAIN

Every recommendation connects a cue to a reason and a consequence. If you know only the move, you do not yet know the opening.

3. PLAY THE DECISION

Generate Black's candidates, find White's strongest reply, and choose the resulting structure you understand. The move is the end of the reasoning, not the beginning.

4. RETRIEVE UNDER PRESSURE

Cover the answer key, reconstruct the line, and speak the memory rule. Review after 1, 3, 7, 14, and 30 days, then test the idea in a slow game.

THEORY WARNING

This is a durable concept-first repertoire, not a claim to be a live engine database. Before tournament use, verify sharp forcing branches in Fritz or a current database.

Priority order at the board: legality and tactical survival, king safety, forcing moves, central transformation, activity, structure, then the remembered rule.

SIX LINKED LESSONS

Recognition first, execution second

LESSON 085 | PAGE 4

*A maneuver is a sequence of jobs, not a tour of squares.***Decode: The e7-d7-f6 knight circuit**

LESSON 086 | PAGE 8

*A maneuver is a sequence of jobs, not a tour of squares.***Play: The e7-d7-f6 knight circuit**

LESSON 087 | PAGE 12

*A blocked bishop may be a sleeping tactical piece and an active defender.***Decode: The dark bishop after the center closes**

LESSON 088 | PAGE 16

*A blocked bishop may be a sleeping tactical piece and an active defender.***Play: The dark bishop after the center closes**

LESSON 089 | PAGE 20

*Heavy pieces belong behind the line that will actually open.***Decode: Queen and rook entry routes**

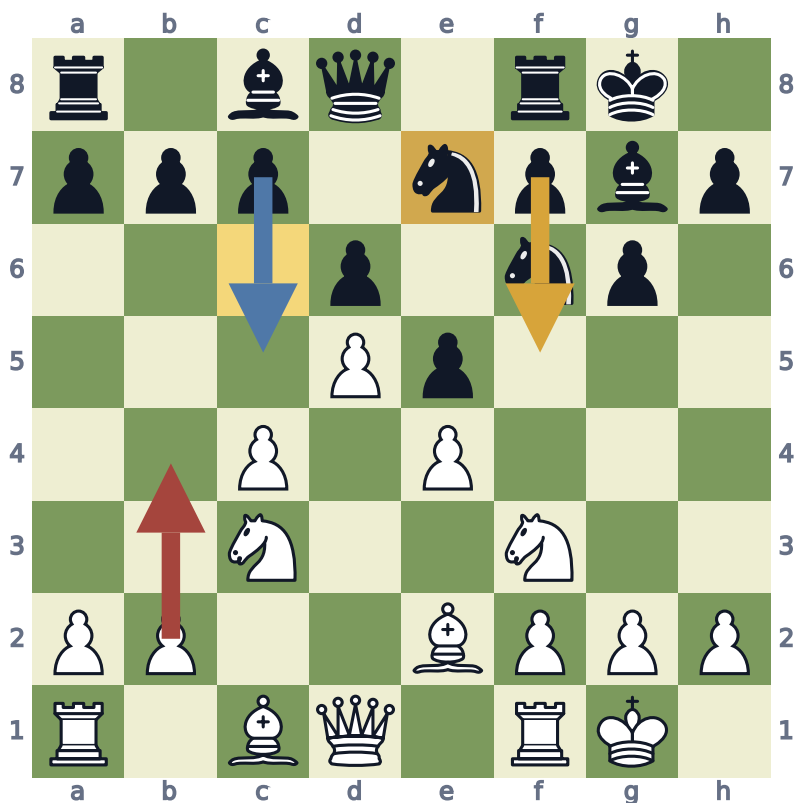
LESSON 090 | PAGE 24

*Heavy pieces belong behind the line that will actually open.***Play: Queen and rook entry routes****VOLUME OBJECTIVE**

Make the famous maneuvers purposeful and know when their usual routes are wrong.

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: The e7-d7-f6 knight circuit

**WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS**

The knight's retreat clears f7-f5, supports c5 and f4 from d7, then returns to f6 after the pawn has advanced.

DECISION RULE

Ask what each knight move enables immediately.

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Time the route against White's queenside break and preserve useful squares for the other knight.

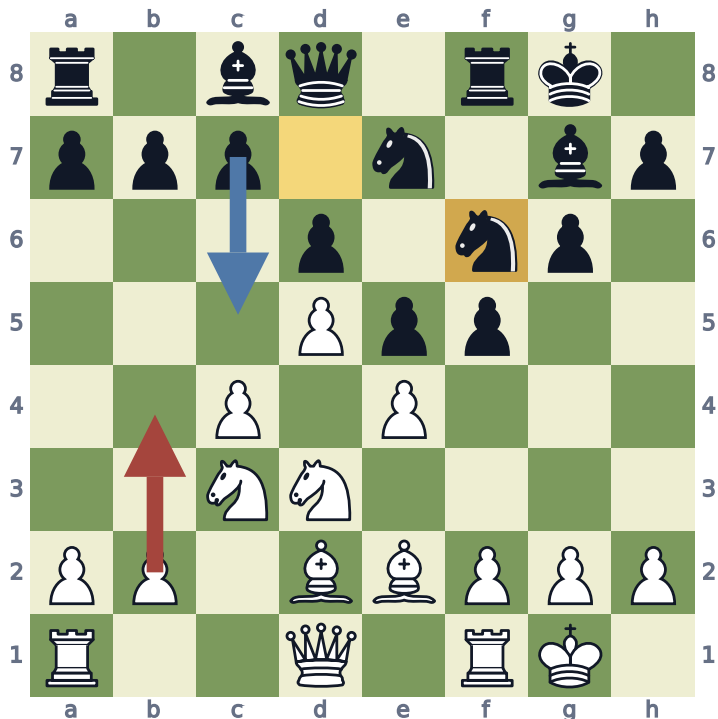
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White gains tempi for c5, b4, and pressure on d6.

MEMORY RULE | A maneuver is a sequence of jobs, not a tour of squares.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

The knight's retreat clears f7-f5, supports c5 and f4 from d7, then returns to f6 after the pawn has advanced.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Time the route against White's queenside break and preserve useful squares for the other knight.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White gains tempi for c5, b4, and pressure on d6.

FAILURE MODE

A thematic circuit played too slowly becomes pure loss of time.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Ask what each knight move enables immediately. Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

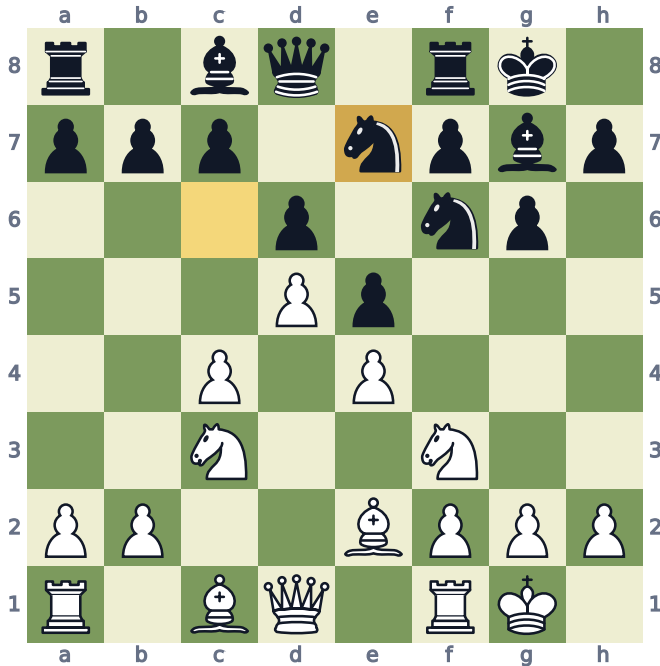
RULE | A maneuver is a sequence of jobs, not a tour of squares.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7 9. Ne1 Nd7 10. Nd3 f5 11. Bd2 Nf6



- Be2: White changes a bishop's diagonal and the balance between development, pressure, and tempo.
- e5: Black makes direct central contact and asks whether White will close, capture, or maintain tension.
- O-O: White secures the king and activates a rook; the central decision can now become concrete.
- Nc6: Black reroutes a knight toward c6; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- d5: White claims space or creates a break that changes Black's available time and squares.
- Ne7: Black reroutes a knight toward e7; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

The knight's retreat clears f7-f5, supports c5 and f4 from d7, then returns to f6 after the pawn has advanced.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Ask what each knight move enables immediately. White's resistance is: White gains tempi for c5, b4, and pressure on d6. The line fails as a template when: A thematic circuit played too slowly becomes pure loss of time.

STORE THIS | A maneuver is a sequence of jobs, not a tour of squares.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

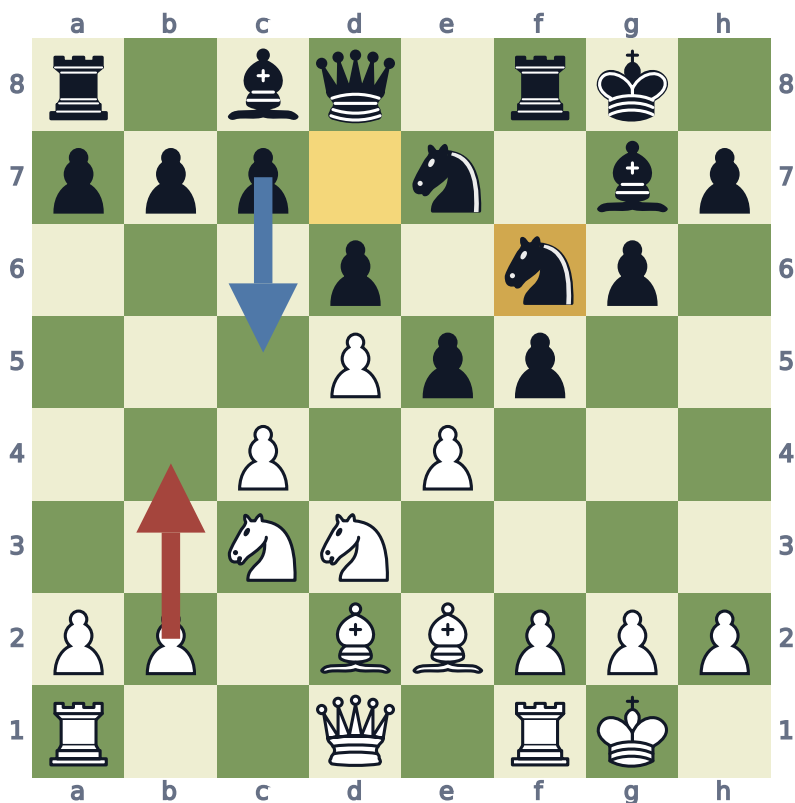
1. The knight's retreat clears f7-f5, supports c5 and f4 from d7, then returns to f6 after the pawn has advanced. 2. Time the route against White's queenside break and preserve useful squares for the other knight. 3. White gains tempi for c5, b4, and pressure on d6. 4. Ask what each knight move enables immediately. 5. A thematic circuit played too slowly becomes pure loss of time.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 16 plies from memory, then replay: 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: The e7-d7-f6 knight circuit



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

The knight's retreat clears f7-f5, supports c5 and f4 from d7, then returns to f6 after the pawn has advanced.

DECISION RULE

Ask what each knight move enables immediately.

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Time the route against White's queenside break and preserve useful squares for the other knight.

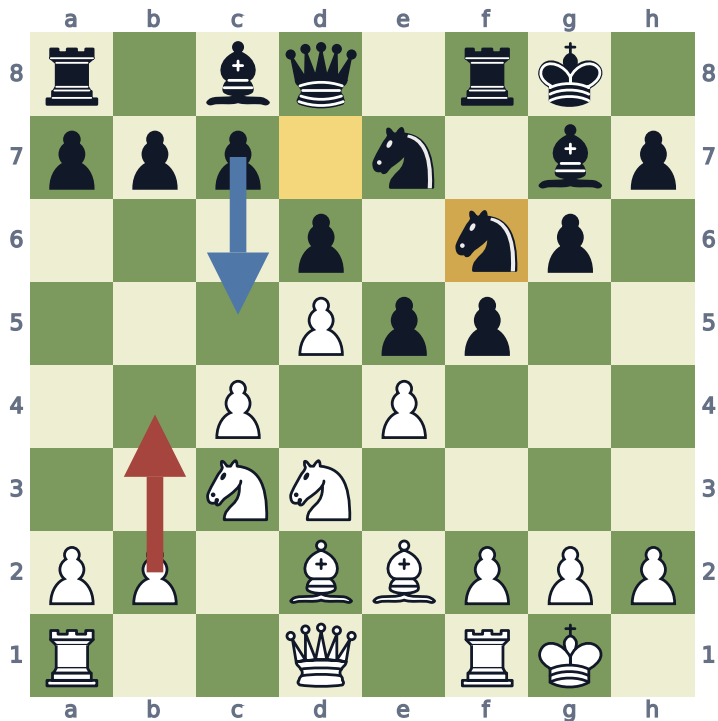
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White gains tempi for c5, b4, and pressure on d6.

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CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

The knight's retreat clears f7-f5, supports c5 and f4 from d7, then returns to f6 after the pawn has advanced.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Time the route against White's queenside break and preserve useful squares for the other knight.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White gains tempi for c5, b4, and pressure on d6.

FAILURE MODE

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Ask: Ask what each knight move enables immediately. Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

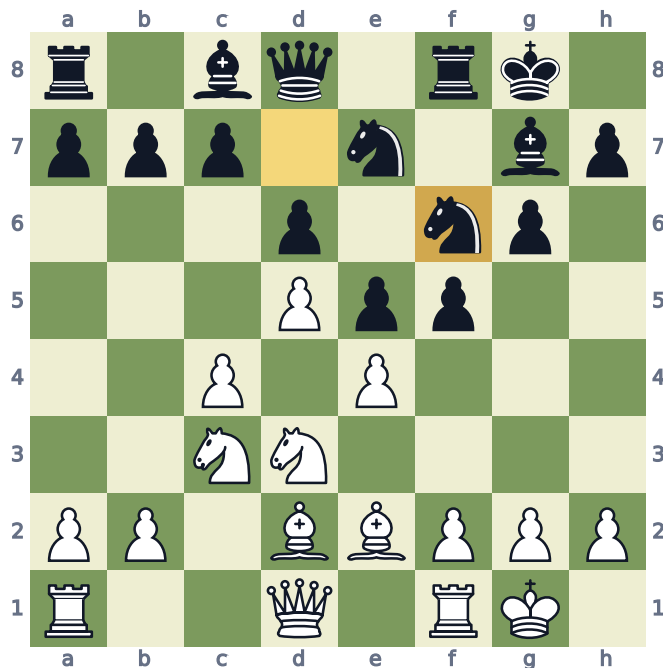
RULE | A maneuver is a sequence of jobs, not a tour of squares.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7 9. Ne1 Nd7 10. Nd3 f5 11. Bd2 Nf6



- Ne1: White reroutes a knight toward e1; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- Nd7: Black reroutes a knight toward d7; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- Nd3: White reroutes a knight toward d3; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- f5: Black begins the thematic kingside break, but its value depends on piece support and race timing.
- Bd2: White changes a bishop's diagonal and the balance between development, pressure, and tempo.
- Nf6: Black reroutes a knight toward f6; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

The knight's retreat clears f7-f5, supports c5 and f4 from d7, then returns to f6 after the pawn has advanced.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

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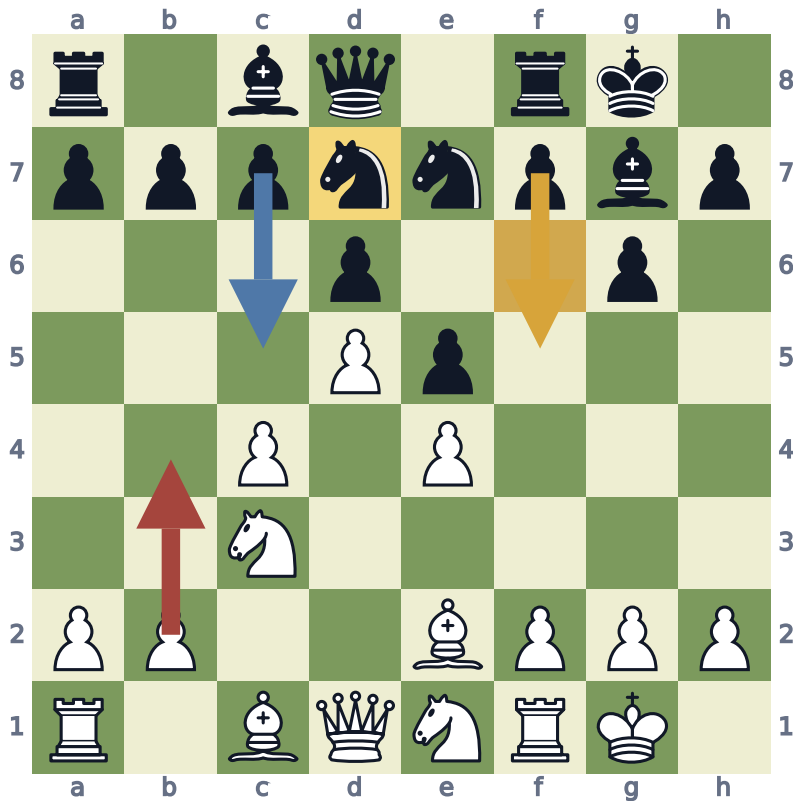
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BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 22 plies from memory, then replay: 9. Ne1 Nd7 10. Nd3 f5 11. Bd2 Nf6

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: The dark bishop after the center closes

**WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS**

The g7-bishop is blocked by e5 and d4, but it defends the king, pressures the center indirectly, and may awaken after captures.

DECISION RULE

Forecast which central exchange will free the bishop.

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Keep the bishop unless an exchange removes a key defender or opens decisive dark squares.

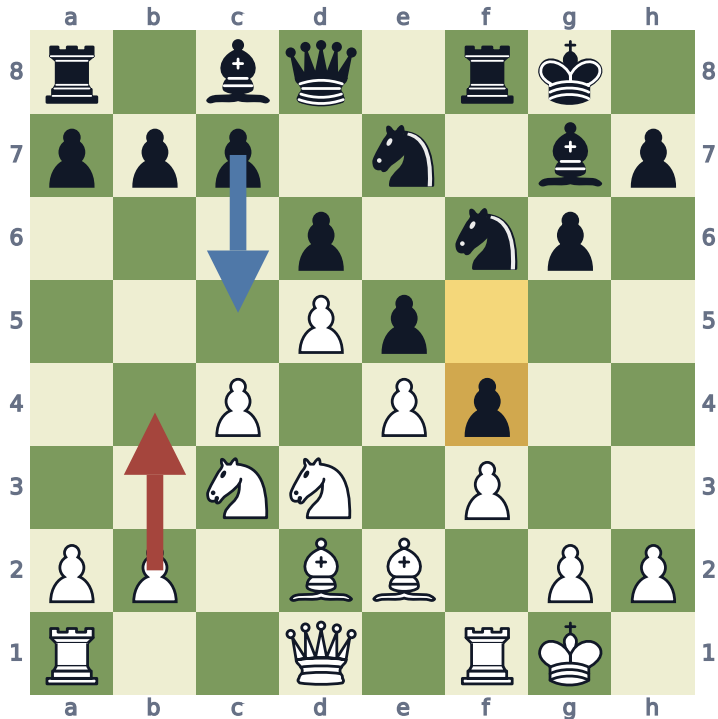
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White may seek c5 and cxd6, changing the long diagonal.

MEMORY RULE | A blocked bishop may be a sleeping tactical piece and an active defender.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

The g7-bishop is blocked by e5 and d4, but it defends the king, pressures the center indirectly, and may awaken after captures.

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Keep the bishop unless an exchange removes a key defender or opens decisive dark squares.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White may seek c5 and cxd6, changing the long diagonal.

FAILURE MODE

Calling the bishop bad can lead to an unnecessary trade that weakens the king.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Forecast which central exchange will free the bishop. Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

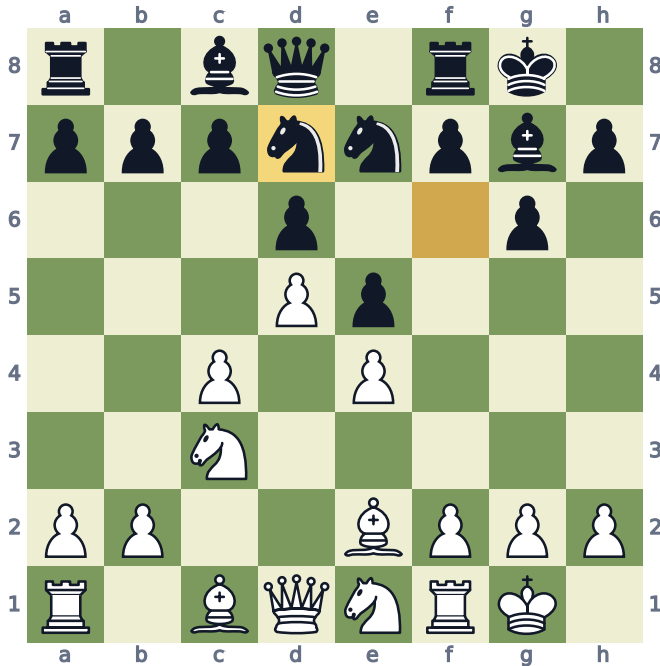
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Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

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- O-O: White secures the king and activates a rook; the central decision can now become concrete.
- Nc6: Black reroutes a knight toward c6; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- d5: White claims space or creates a break that changes Black's available time and squares.
- Ne7: Black reroutes a knight toward e7; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- Ne1: White reroutes a knight toward e1; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- Nd7: Black reroutes a knight toward d7; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

The g7-bishop is blocked by e5 and d4, but it defends the king, pressures the center indirectly, and may awaken after captures.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Forecast which central exchange will free the bishop. White's resistance is: White may seek c5 and cxd6, changing the long diagonal. The line fails as a template when: Calling the bishop bad can lead to an unnecessary trade that weakens the king.

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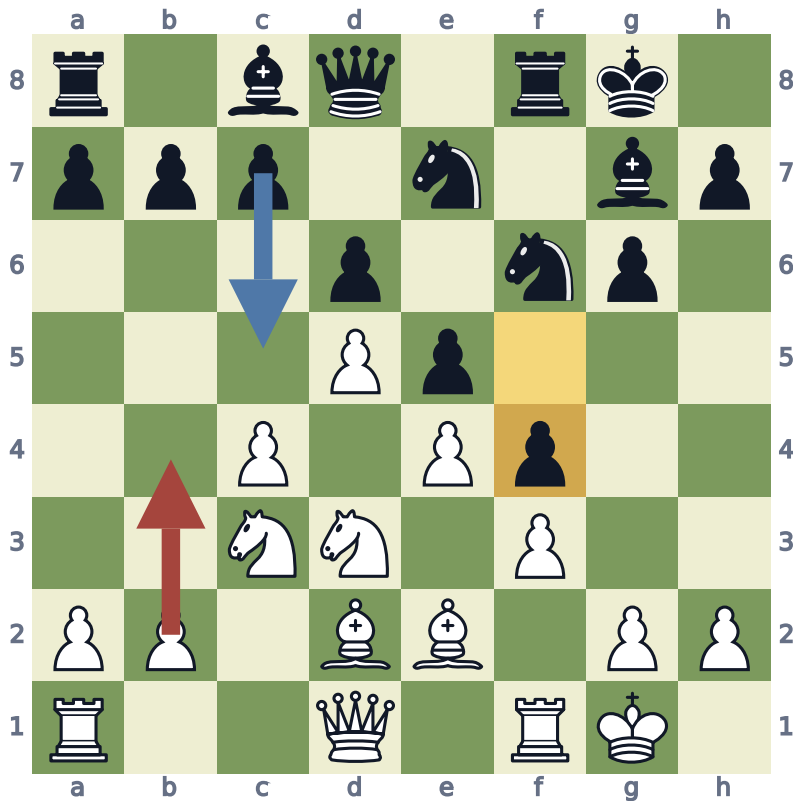
1. The g7-bishop is blocked by e5 and d4, but it defends the king, pressures the center indirectly, and may awaken after captures. 2. Keep the bishop unless an exchange removes a key defender or opens decisive dark squares. 3. White may seek c5 and cxd6, changing the long diagonal. 4. Forecast which central exchange will free the bishop. 5. Calling the bishop bad can lead to an unnecessary trade that weakens the king.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 18 plies from memory, then replay: 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7 9. Ne1 Nd7

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: The dark bishop after the center closes



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

The g7-bishop is blocked by e5 and d4, but it defends the king, pressures the center indirectly, and may awaken after captures.

DECISION RULE

Forecast which central exchange will free the bishop.

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Keep the bishop unless an exchange removes a key defender or opens decisive dark squares.

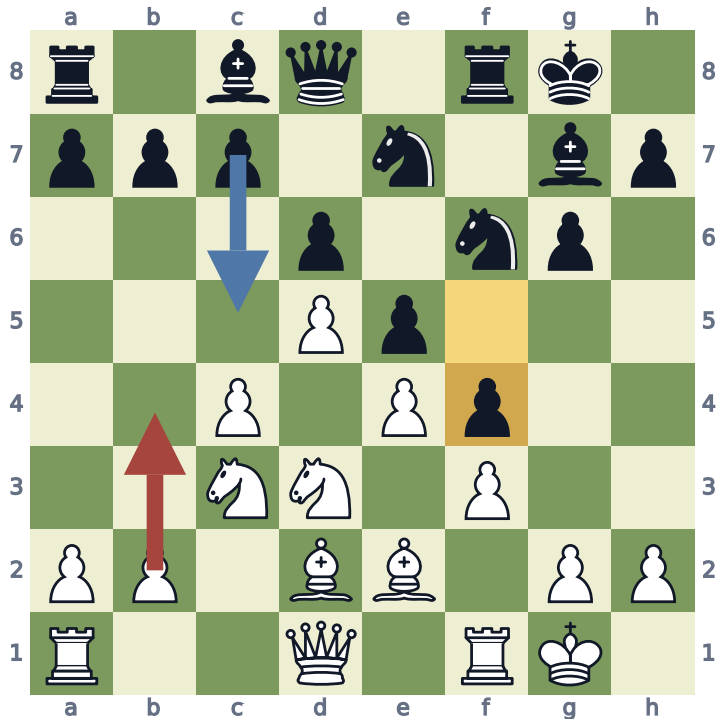
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White may seek c5 and cxd6, changing the long diagonal.

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CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

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FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

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FAILURE MODE

Calling the bishop bad can lead to an unnecessary trade that weakens the king.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Forecast which central exchange will free the bishop. Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

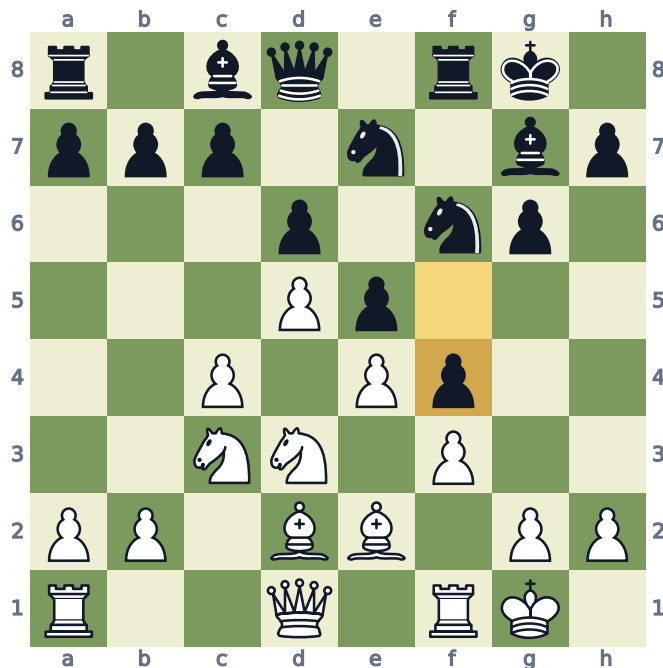
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Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

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- Nd3: White reroutes a knight toward d3; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- f5: Black begins the thematic kingside break, but its value depends on piece support and race timing.
- Bd2: White changes a bishop's diagonal and the balance between development, pressure, and tempo.
- Nf6: Black reroutes a knight toward f6; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- f3: White changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, open lines, and weakened squares.
- f4: Black gains or fixes kingside space and prepares line-opening contact for the pieces.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

The g7-bishop is blocked by e5 and d4, but it defends the king, pressures the center indirectly, and may awaken after captures.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Forecast which central exchange will free the bishop. White's resistance is: White may seek c5 and cxd6, changing the long diagonal. The line fails as a template when: Calling the bishop bad can lead to an unnecessary trade that weakens the king.

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COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

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ANSWER KEY

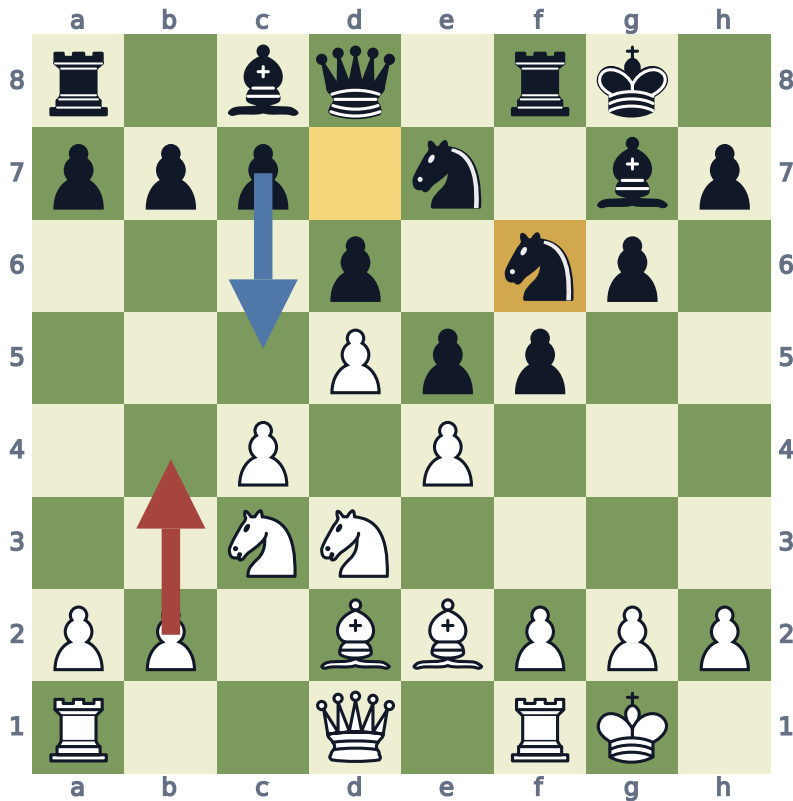
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BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 24 plies from memory, then replay: 10. Nd3 f5 11. Bd2 Nf6 12. f3 f4

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: Queen and rook entry routes



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

Once pawn contact is prepared, the queen may enter through e8, g6, or h4 while rooks use f7-f8 or g-file openings.

DECISION RULE

Before moving the queen, identify the opponent's forcing reply and the queen's retreat.

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Choose an entry route based on the file that will open, not on a memorized diagram.

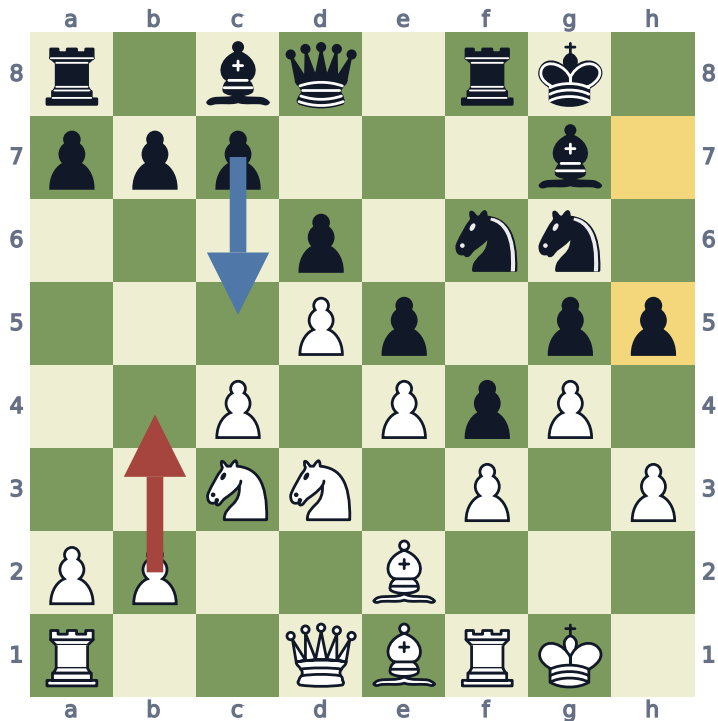
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White may trade queens, close lines, or counter in the center.

MEMORY RULE | Heavy pieces belong behind the line that will actually open.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

Once pawn contact is prepared, the queen may enter through e8, g6, or h4 while rooks use f7-f8 or g-file openings.

BLACK AIMS FOR

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FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White may trade queens, close lines, or counter in the center.

FAILURE MODE

A queen placed early can be chased while the queenside collapses.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Before moving the queen, identify the opponent's forcing reply and the queen's retreat. Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

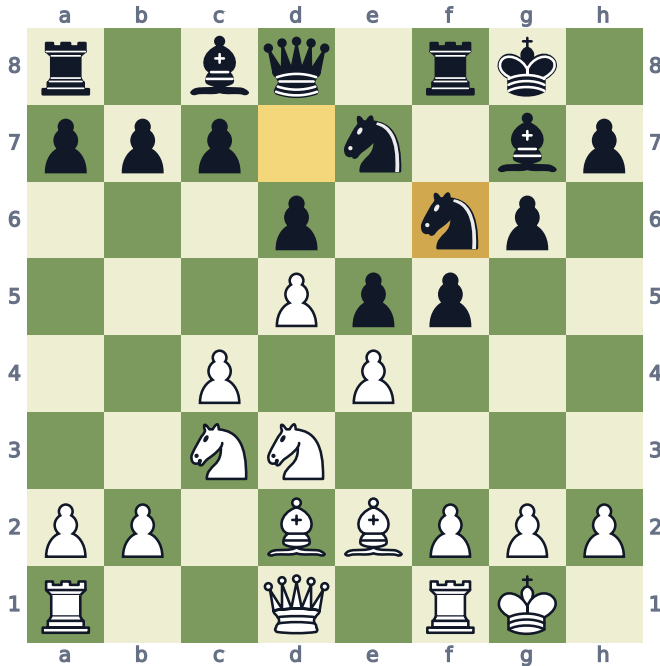
RULE | Heavy pieces belong behind the line that will actually open.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7 9. Ne1 Nd7 10. Nd3 f5 11. Bd2 Nf6 12. f3 f4 13. Be1 g5 14. g4 Ng6 15. h3 h5



- Ne1: White reroutes a knight toward e1; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- Nd7: Black reroutes a knight toward d7; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- Nd3: White reroutes a knight toward d3; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- f5: Black begins the thematic kingside break, but its value depends on piece support and race timing.
- Bd2: White changes a bishop's diagonal and the balance between development, pressure, and tempo.
- Nf6: Black reroutes a knight toward f6; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

Once pawn contact is prepared, the queen may enter through e8, g6, or h4 while rooks use f7-f8 or g-file openings.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Before moving the queen, identify the opponent's forcing reply and the queen's retreat. White's resistance is: White may trade queens, close lines, or counter in the center. The line fails as a template when: A queen placed early can be chased while the queenside collapses.

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COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

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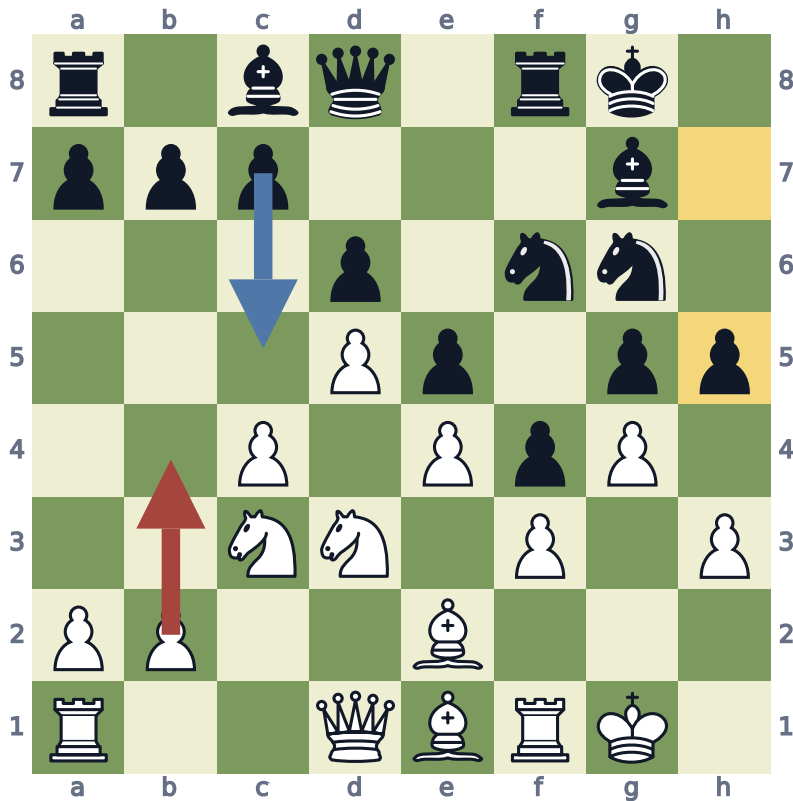
1. Once pawn contact is prepared, the queen may enter through e8, g6, or h4 while rooks use f7-f8 or g-file openings. 2. Choose an entry route based on the file that will open, not on a memorized diagram. 3. White may trade queens, close lines, or counter in the center. 4. Before moving the queen, identify the opponent's forcing reply and the queen's retreat. 5. A queen placed early can be chased while the queenside collapses.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 22 plies from memory, then replay: 9. Ne1 Nd7 10. Nd3 f5 11. Bd2 Nf6

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: Queen and rook entry routes



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

Once pawn contact is prepared, the queen may enter through e8, g6, or h4 while rooks use f7-f8 or g-file openings.

DECISION RULE

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SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

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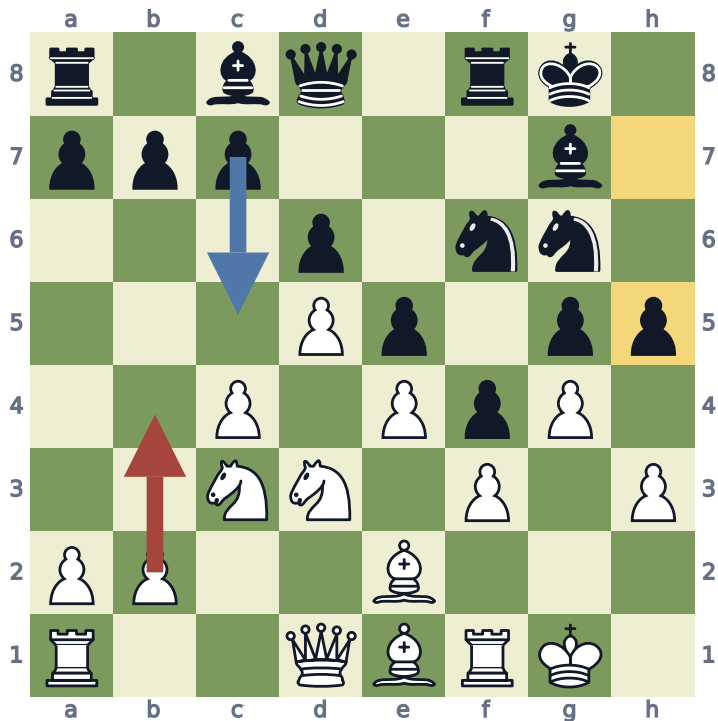
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CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

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White may trade queens, close lines, or counter in the center.

FAILURE MODE

A queen placed early can be chased while the queenside collapses.

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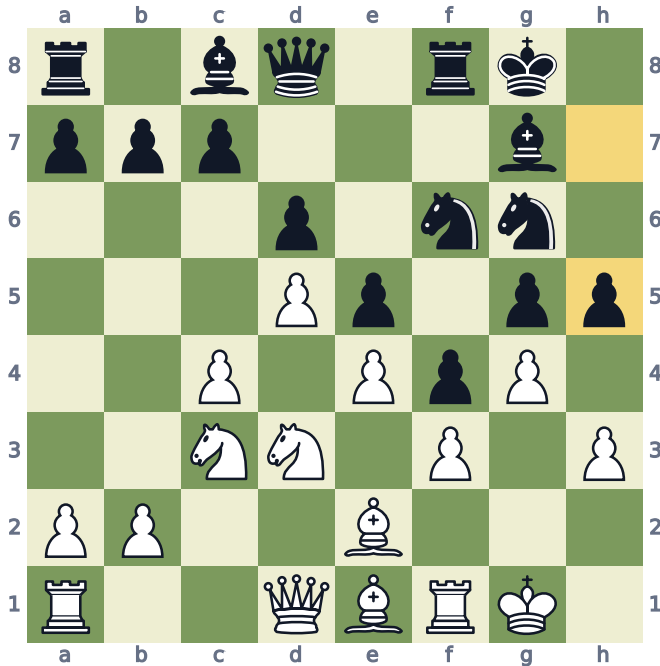
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- Be1: White changes a bishop's diagonal and the balance between development, pressure, and tempo.
- g5: Black gains or fixes kingside space and prepares line-opening contact for the pieces.
- g4: White claims space or creates a break that changes Black's available time and squares.
- Ng6: Black reroutes a knight toward g6; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- h3: White changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, open lines, and weakened squares.
- h5: Black gains or fixes kingside space and prepares line-opening contact for the pieces.

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Once pawn contact is prepared, the queen may enter through e8, g6, or h4 while rooks use f7-f8 or g-file openings.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Before moving the queen, identify the opponent's forcing reply and the queen's retreat. White's resistance is: White may trade queens, close lines, or counter in the center. The line fails as a template when: A queen placed early can be chased while the queenside collapses.

STORE THIS | Heavy pieces belong behind the line that will actually open.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

1. Once pawn contact is prepared, the queen may enter through e8, g6, or h4 while rooks use f7-f8 or g-file openings. 2. Choose an entry route based on the file that will open, not on a memorized diagram. 3. White may trade queens, close lines, or counter in the center. 4. Before moving the queen, identify the opponent's forcing reply and the queen's retreat. 5. A queen placed early can be chased while the queenside collapses.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 30 plies from memory, then replay: 13. Be1 g5 14. g4 Ng6 15. h3 h5

SIX-POSITION TEST

Can you retrieve the plan without the chapter?

LESSON 085 Decode: The e7-d7-f6 knight circuit

Prompt: Ask what each knight move enables immediately.

Recall: A maneuver is a sequence of jobs, not a tour of squares.

LESSON 086 Play: The e7-d7-f6 knight circuit

Prompt: Ask what each knight move enables immediately.

Recall: A maneuver is a sequence of jobs, not a tour of squares.

LESSON 087 Decode: The dark bishop after the center closes

Prompt: Forecast which central exchange will free the bishop.

Recall: A blocked bishop may be a sleeping tactical piece and an active defender.

LESSON 088 Play: The dark bishop after the center closes

Prompt: Forecast which central exchange will free the bishop.

Recall: A blocked bishop may be a sleeping tactical piece and an active defender.

LESSON 089 Decode: Queen and rook entry routes

Prompt: Before moving the queen, identify the opponent's forcing reply and the queen's retreat.

Recall: Heavy pieces belong behind the line that will actually open.

LESSON 090 Play: Queen and rook entry routes

Prompt: Before moving the queen, identify the opponent's forcing reply and the queen's retreat.

Recall: Heavy pieces belong behind the line that will actually open.

PASS STANDARD

For each position: name the structure, Black's plan, White's counterplay, one candidate, the strongest reply, and the failure mode. Score one point each; 30 of 36 is a pass.

THREE SCENARIOS TO STORE

One-page repertoire memory sheet

CARD 1

The e7-d7-f6 knight circuit

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7 9. Ne1 Nd7 10. Nd3 f5 11. Bd2 Nf6

Decision: Ask what each knight move enables immediately.

Memory: A maneuver is a sequence of jobs, not a tour of squares.

CARD 2

The dark bishop after the center closes

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7 9. Ne1 Nd7 10. Nd3 f5 11. Bd2 Nf6 12. f3 f4

Decision: Forecast which central exchange will free the bishop.

Memory: A blocked bishop may be a sleeping tactical piece and an active defender.

CARD 3

Queen and rook entry routes

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7 9. Ne1 Nd7 10. Nd3 f5 11. Bd2 Nf6 12. f3 f4 13. Be1 g5 14. g4 Ng6 15. h3 h5

Decision: Before moving the queen, identify the opponent's forcing reply and the queen's retreat.

Memory: Heavy pieces belong behind the line that will actually open.

Reconstruct each card from the final position, then from the opening moves alone.

SPACED RETRIEVAL AND GAME TRANSFER

Volume mastery tracker

Lesson	D1	D3	D7	D14	D30	Game	Pass
085 Decode: The e7-d7-f6 knight circuit	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
086 Play: The e7-d7-f6 knight circuit	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
087 Decode: The dark bishop after the center closes	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
088 Play: The dark bishop after the center closes	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
089 Decode: Queen and rook entry routes	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
090 Play: Queen and rook entry routes	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

TWELVE-WEEK CYCLE

Weeks 1-2: decode the three structures. Weeks 3-4: replay all lines from memory. Weeks 5-7: solve the workbook pages. Weeks 8-10: test in slow games or against Fritz. Weeks 11-12: analyze failures and retest the volume examination.

PROMOTION RULE

Advance only when you can explain every memory rule, reproduce the three reference lines, name White's best counterplay, and show at least one analyzed game where the decision appeared.

Do not measure mastery by pages completed. Measure whether the correct questions appear during a real game.